

A Day in San Sebastián

In July and September the beautiful people flock to San Sebastián for, respectively, the annual jazz and film festivals, but the decorous city and beachside promenade are just as delightful when the paparazzi and their targets have left town. Be sure to arrive hungry.

MORNING Explore the narrow streets of the **Parte Vieja**, or old quarter, which was rebuilt on the medieval street plan after Napoleon burned the city. At the harbor, explore the fishermen's docks and visit the **Palacio del Mar**, San Sebastián's intriguing aquarium, focused on the marine life of the Bay of Biscay.

AFTERNOON Walk up the circular road around **Monte Urgull** to see the 12th-century ruins of the **Castillo de Santa Cruz de la Mota**. Then catch some sun on **Playa de la Concha**.

EVENING Ride the funicular to the summit of **Monte Igeldo** to survey the city from this western headland. Then return to town for an evening of bar-hopping to sample the city's inventive *pintxos* (Basque tapas) before winding up at a fine restaurant for dinner.

Essentials

GETTING THERE

San Sebastián Airport has domestic flights; the **international airports** of Bilbao and Biarritz are relatively close. The city can also be reached by **train** on the **TGV Paris–Madrid** route, and by **bus** from many European cities.

WHERE TO STAY

Hotel Niza (inexpensive) offers airy rooms with Playa de la Concha views. www.hotelniza.com
Hotel de Londres y de Inglaterra (moderate) is a restored *belle époque* resort hotel with traditional furnishings. www.hlondres.com
Hotel María Cristina (expensive) is San Sebastián's most palatial hotel, with luxurious appointments in even the simplest rooms. www.luxurycollection.com/MariaCristina

TOURIST INFORMATION

Boulevard 8; www.sansebastianturismo.com



Right Monkfish and minted beans with Iberian tomato ravioli and Jerez vinegar by Basque chef Juan Mari Arzak

Below The uninhabited island of Santa Clara lies just off the scallop-shaped coastline of San Sebastián

